

# Voyage

Guided content for kids

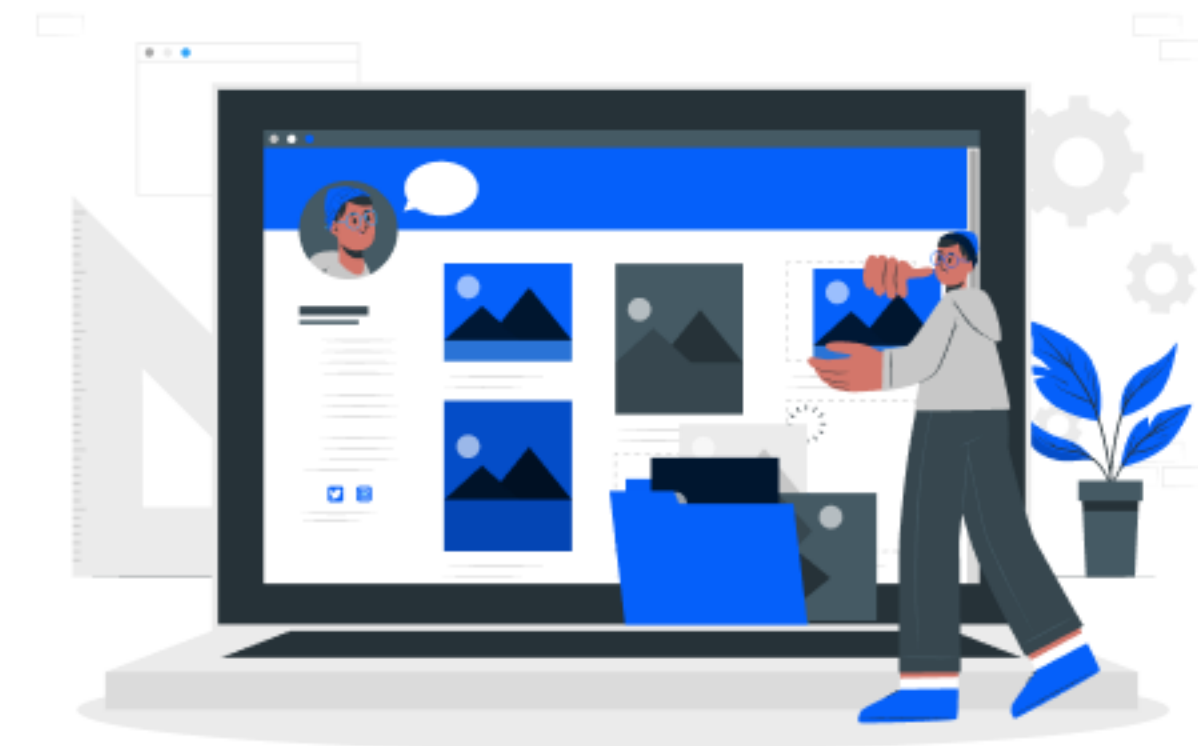


# Problem Statement

Children today are growing up in a digital world dominated by short-form video platforms designed to maximize attention, not learning. These platforms encourage endless scrolling, rapid dopamine rewards, and passive consumption, often exposing children to content that is unfiltered, unsafe, or developmentally misaligned.

Parents, on the other hand, lack meaningful control and visibility. While they want to support their child's learning, they are often forced to rely on screens as a convenience tool, without knowing what their child is watching, why it is being shown, or what value it provides.

The challenge is not to remove screens from children's lives. It is to redefine how screens are used.





# Design Challenge

The challenge is to design a dual-app ecosystem where:

- Parents define learning intent and boundaries,
- Children explore content freely within safe limits,
- Video remains engaging without becoming addictive,
- Content is transparent, explainable, and purpose-driven,
- Curiosity, learning, and safety coexist without over-restriction

This is not about restricting children.  
It is about guiding **curiosity** with **care**.



# Project Overview

Voyage is a kids first video content platform that uses theme-based storytelling to transform screen time into meaningful exploration.

Instead of endless scrolling, children enter story driven themes, guided by an AI Mascot that is interactive and helps children throughout the app, each designed as a short journey made up of carefully curated video chapters. It allow children to explore ideas through stories rather than random clips. Whether it's discovering how rain is formed, learning kindness through characters, or understanding numbers through adventures, learning unfolds naturally through narrative.

Parents define what their child should explore by selecting themes such as science, values, creativity, or language. Voyage then translates these intents into safe, age appropriate storytelling journeys that guide curiosity without restricting it. Children remain in control of their choices, while the platform ensures that every story, video, and interaction has a clear purpose.



# Research Summary

Due to the time-bound nature of the competition, primary research through surveys and in-person interviews was not feasible. Instead, research was conducted using a secondary research driven approach, combining insights from existing studies, articles, and expert discussions to understand both children's content consumption patterns and parental concerns.

**The research was based on:**

- Published articles and reports on children's screen habits and attention spans
- Academic research papers on digital addiction and short-form video consumption
- Online interviews and panel discussions with parents, educators, and child psychologists

This approach helped identify consistent patterns across sources, particularly around dopamine driven scrolling behaviors in children and parental anxiety around algorithmic opacity.

## Research references are given below:

- Short-Form Video Media Use Is Associated With Greater Inattentive Symptoms in Thai School-Age Children: Insights From a Cross-Sectional Survey – [pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/36111111/)
- How short videos keep kids hooked and 7 ways to help – [qustodio.com](https://www.qustodio.com/)
- Media Use and Screen Time – Its Impact on Children, Adolescents, and Families – [acped.org](https://www.acped.org/)
- The mediating role of short video viewing and other types of screen activities between parenting styles and children's personality traits – [sciencedirect.com](https://www.sciencedirect.com/)
- AI, socials & short-form content: how kids are consuming media in 2024 – [djsresearch.co.uk](https://www.djsresearch.co.uk/)
- 'I tried to take my phone off my daughter, and i got hit in the face': a qualitative study of parents' challenges with adolescents' screen use and a toolbox of their tips – [pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/36111111/)
- Do you use your phone 52 times a day? Then it's time for a digital detox – [parentcircle.com](https://www.parentcircle.com/)

# Key Insights

## **1. Short form content fragments attention**

Short form content overstimulates children through constant novelty and dopamine spikes, leading to fragmented attention and reduced concentration over time.

## **2. Parents fear the unknown**

Most parental anxiety comes from not knowing why a video was shown or what their child is learning from it.

## **3. Educational apps feel forced to children**

Learning platforms often feel like school, causing kids to disengage quickly despite good content.

## **4. Algorithms optimize engagement, not growth**

Existing platforms prioritize watch time over developmental value, creating distrust among parents.

## **5. Content Influences Behavior**

Children copy what they see. Repeated exposure to aggressive or chaotic content can directly influence their behavior.



# Market Analysis

## STRENGTHS

### YOUTUBE KIDS

- Huge content library with high variety and high availability
- Familiar interface for both parents and kids
- Basic parental controls of age filters, screen time etc.

### TIK TOK/REELS

- Extremely engaging short-form format
- High novelty keeps kids interested
- Fast discovery and variety of content

### EDUCATION FIRST APPS

- High quality and expert reviewed content
- Strong parental trust
- Curriculum aligned learning
- Safe and ad free environments

## WEAKNESSES

- Algorithm is still opaque and engagement-driven
- Unsafe or irrelevant content can slip through
- Feed based design encourages passive scrolling

- Designed for dopamine addiction, not learning
- Infinite scroll removes natural stopping points
- No learning intent or age sensitive curation

- Effective for teaching, but not engaging for self driven exploration
- Low engagement compared to video platforms
- Limited to zero storytelling or short form formats



## Key Market Gaps & Problems:

- **Lack of transparency:**

Parents have little visibility into why content is recommended, making platforms feel untrustworthy.

- **Overstimulation and attention loss:**

Infinite short-form videos rely on rapid novelty and dopamine spikes, which fragment children's attention and reduce sustained focus.

- **Behavioral influence:**

Children imitate what they repeatedly watch, exposure to aggressive or chaotic content can shape emotional responses and behavior.

- **Forced tradeoff:**

Existing platforms either offer high engagement without safety or safe content without engaging exploration.

## Opportunities:

- **Intent-first experience:**

Parents select learning themes, not videos, directly connecting intent to outcomes and eliminating algorithmic guesswork.

- **Theme-based video journeys:**

Short videos are structured as chapters with clear beginnings and endings, reducing impulsive scrolling and supporting sustained attention.

- **Explainable curation:**

Every recommendation includes a clear reason, building parental trust through transparency.

- **Emotionally responsible content:**

Stories are curated for tone, values, and consequences, ensuring content shapes behavior positively.

- **Addiction-free design:**

No autoplay, no ads, no external loops, engagement is preserved without dark patterns.



# User Personas

Sunita is a non-tech-savvy parent who uses her phone as a practical tool while managing work and household tasks. She often gives her child the phone but worries about unsafe or confusing content. Complex settings and long instructions overwhelm her, so she avoids parental controls altogether. What she needs is a platform that is safe by default, simple to use, and offers reassurance without effort.



**Name:** Sunita  
**Age:** 34  
**Role:** Housewife  
**Digital Literacy:** Low

## GOALS-

- Keep her child engaged while she works
- Ensure content is safe and positive
- Avoid complicated setup

## How Voyage Supports-

- Theme selection instead of settings
- Weekly voice + visual summary
- No content management required

## NEEDS-

- Very simple setup
- Clear visuals instead of text
- Reassurance without effort

## PAIN POINTS-

- Confused by settings and menus
- Doesn't trust algorithms or recommendations
- Feels helpless when something strange appears on screen





**Name:** Rahul  
**Age:** 37  
**Role:** Lawyer  
**Digital Literacy:** High

Rahul is a tech-savvy parent who sees screen time as an opportunity for learning rather than just entertainment. He actively looks for platforms that balance engagement with educational value, but often feels frustrated by rigid learning apps and opaque recommendation systems. He values transparency, flexibility, and insight over strict control, and prefers guiding curiosity rather than limiting it.

#### **GOALS-**

- Encourage learning through video
- Track interests and progress
- Balance fun with structure

#### **How Voyage Supports-**

- Theme-based journey unlocks
- Skill and interest map
- Clear “why this theme” explanations

#### **NEEDS-**

- Explainable system
- Progress insights
- Intent-driven exploration

#### **PAIN POINTS-**

- Learning apps feel too rigid and school-like
- Entertainment apps feel unsafe and random
- No visibility into why content is recommended



Aarav is a pre-reading child who explores the digital world through touch, sound, and visuals. He cannot read instructions, so text-heavy apps quickly frustrate him. He is drawn to bright visuals and quick interactions, but loses interest when experiences feel confusing or repetitive. Aarav needs simple, visual navigation and story led experiences that let him explore without needing to read or understand complex steps.



**Name:** Aarav

**Age:** 5

**Reading ability:**  
Cannot read

**Behavior:** Curious,  
impulsive, visual  
learner

#### **GOALS-**

- Watch engaging and fun video stories
- Listen to simple, guided narratives
- Explore content freely without limits

#### **How Voyage Supports-**

- Audio-led themes guide exploration
- Visual story maps replace menus
- Tap-only navigation without confusion

#### **NEEDS-**

- Voice guidance for every interaction
- Large, clear icons for navigation
- Short stories with clear endings

#### **PAIN POINTS-**

- Cannot read text-based instructions yet
- Complex menus cause quick frustration
- Loses interest when content repeats





**Name:** Kiara

**Age:** 10

**Reading ability:**

Fluent reader

**Behavior:** Goal oriented, independent

Kiara is an independent, goal-oriented child who enjoys finishing tasks and discovering new ideas on her own. She finds endless scrolling empty and repetitive, but also feels bored by apps that are too structured or school-like. Kiara wants autonomy with direction, along with a clear sense of progress. She values meaningful choices, and experiences that make learning feel like an adventure rather than a lesson.

#### **GOALS-**

- Complete meaningful journeys from start to end
- Choose what to explore next independently
- Feel visible progress and achievement

#### **How Voyage Supports-**

- Chapter-based journeys with clear endings
- Visible completion and progress markers
- New themes unlocked through exploration

#### **NEEDS-**

- Clear structure that guides exploration
- Freedom to choose within safe boundaries
- Feedback that shows learning progress

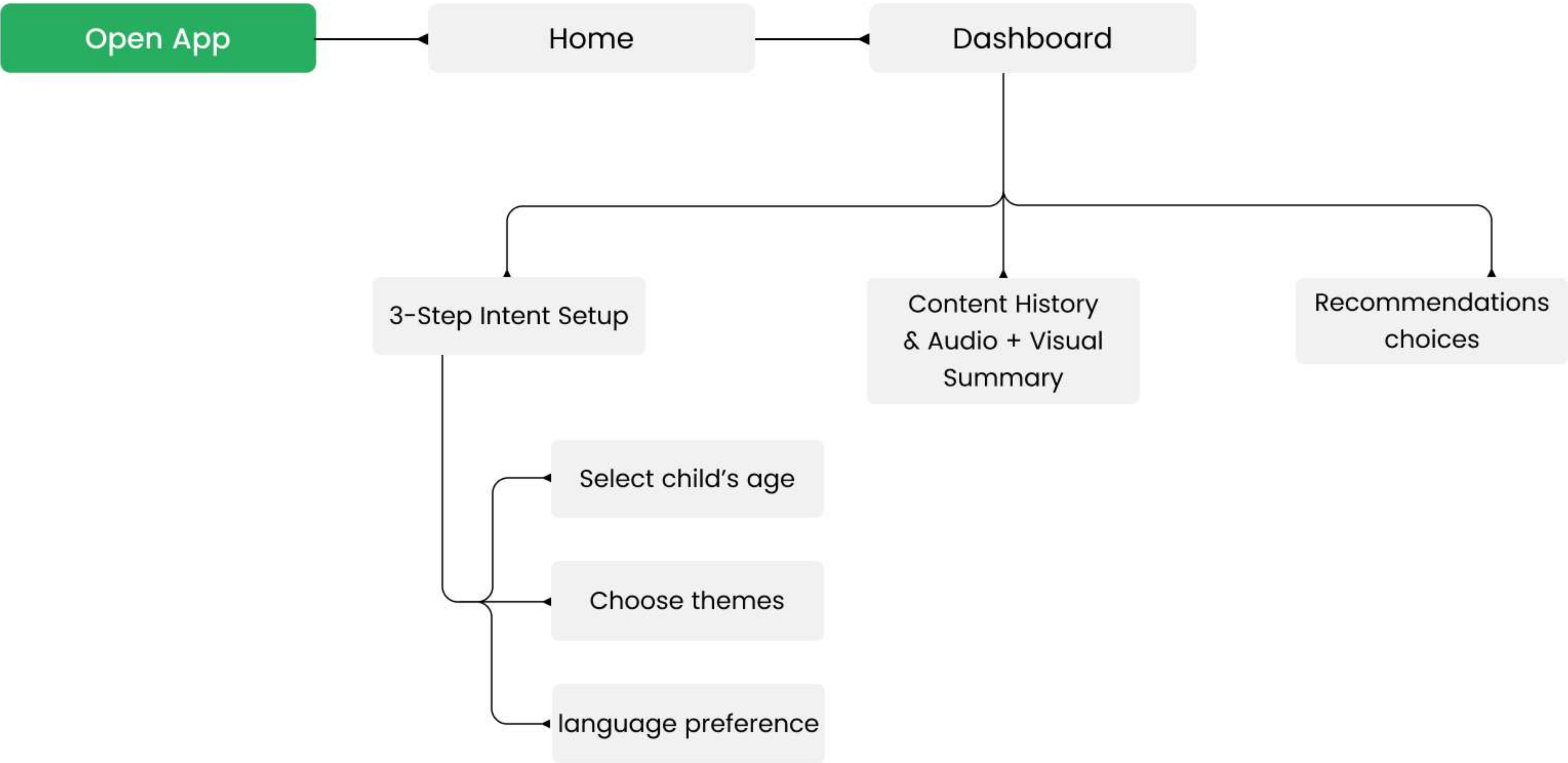
#### **PAIN POINTS-**

- Endless scrolling feels empty and unrewarding
- Too many choices create decision fatigue
- Educational content feels boring and forced

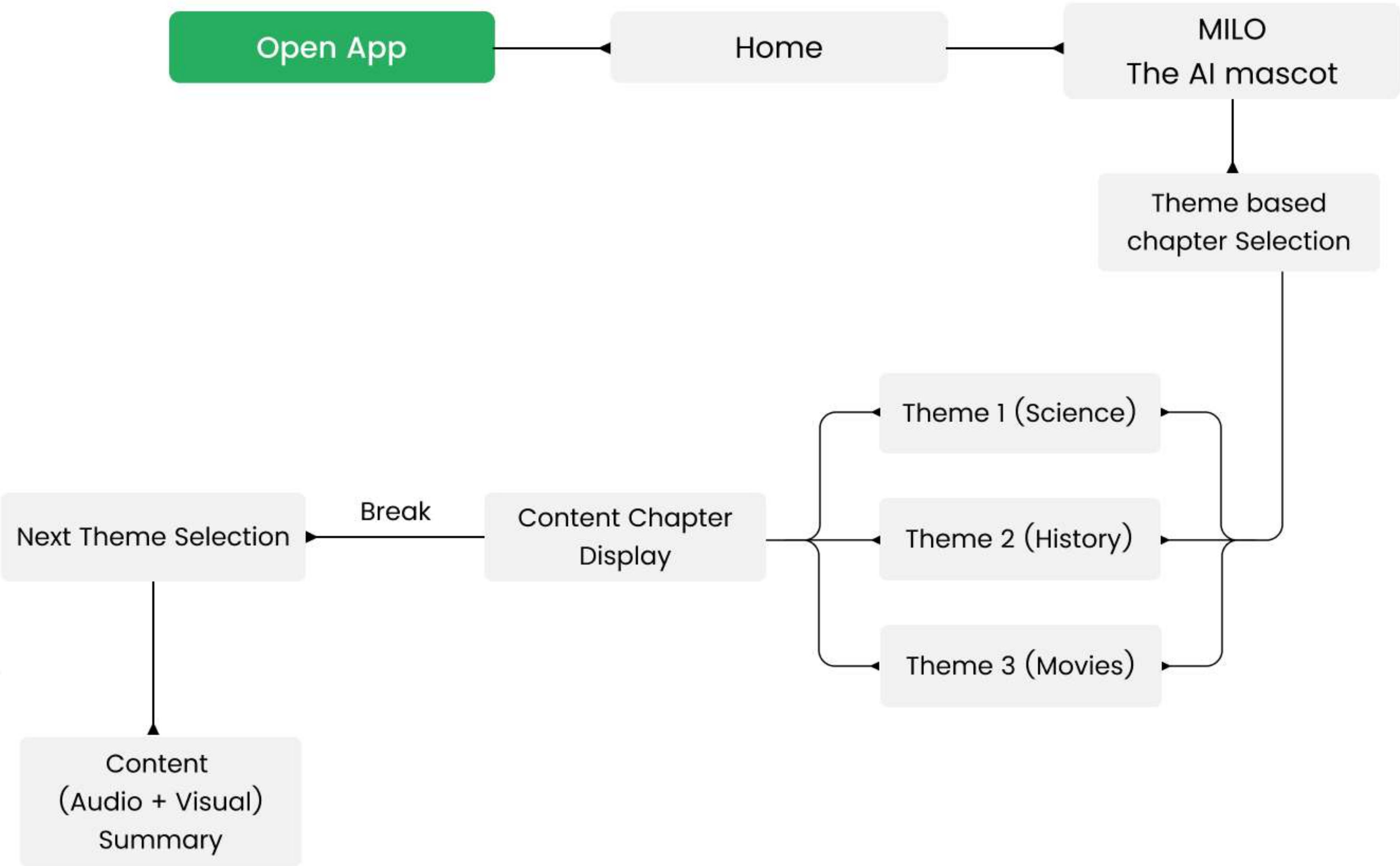


# User Journeys

## 1. Parent Defines Learning Intent

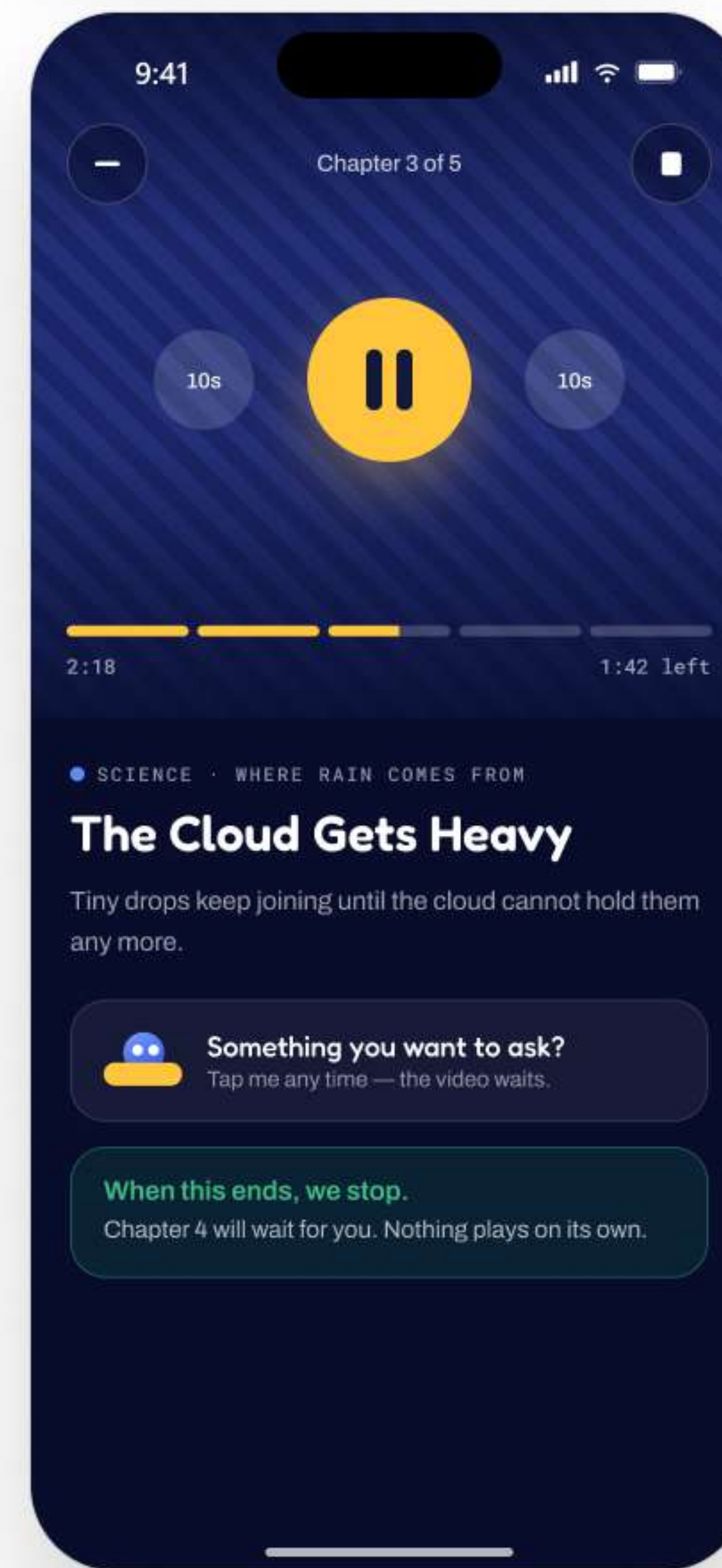
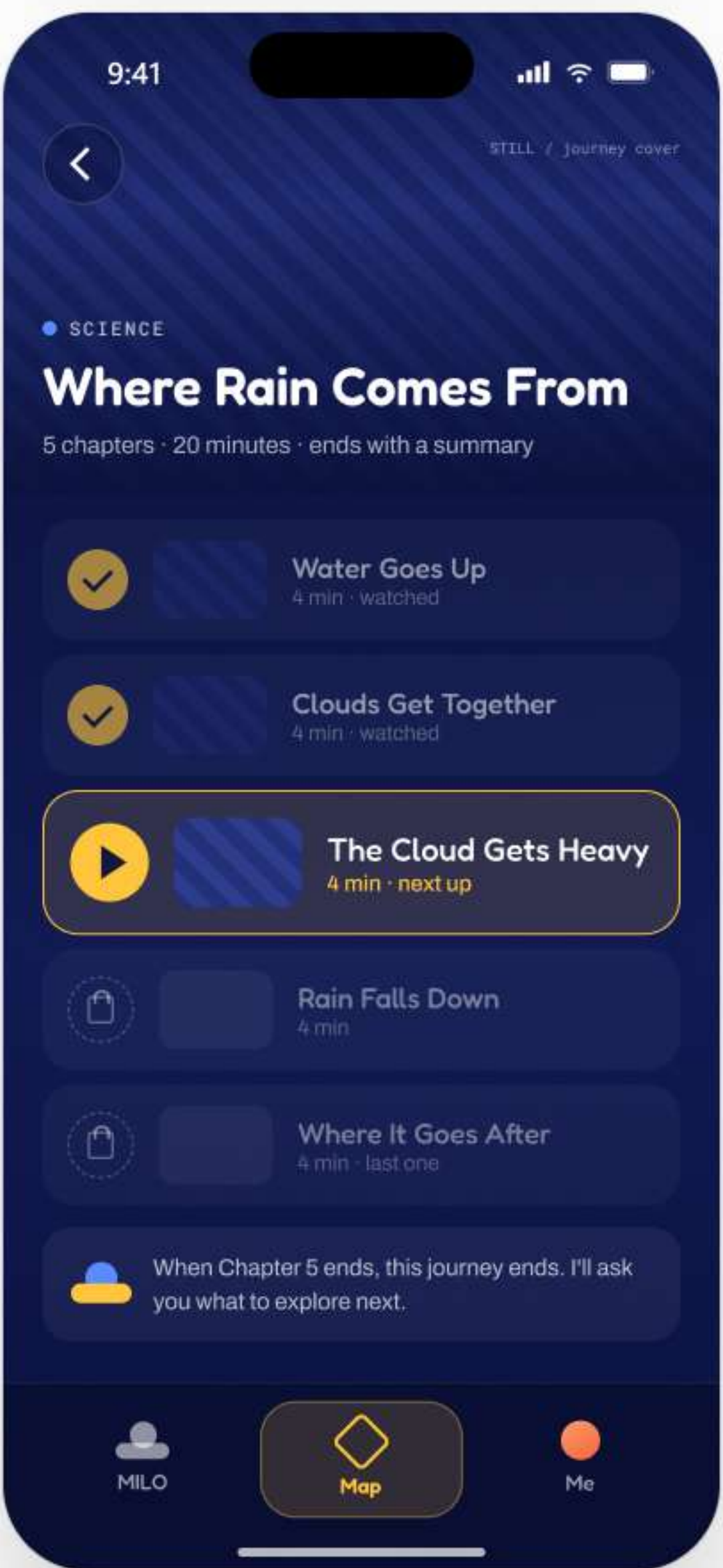
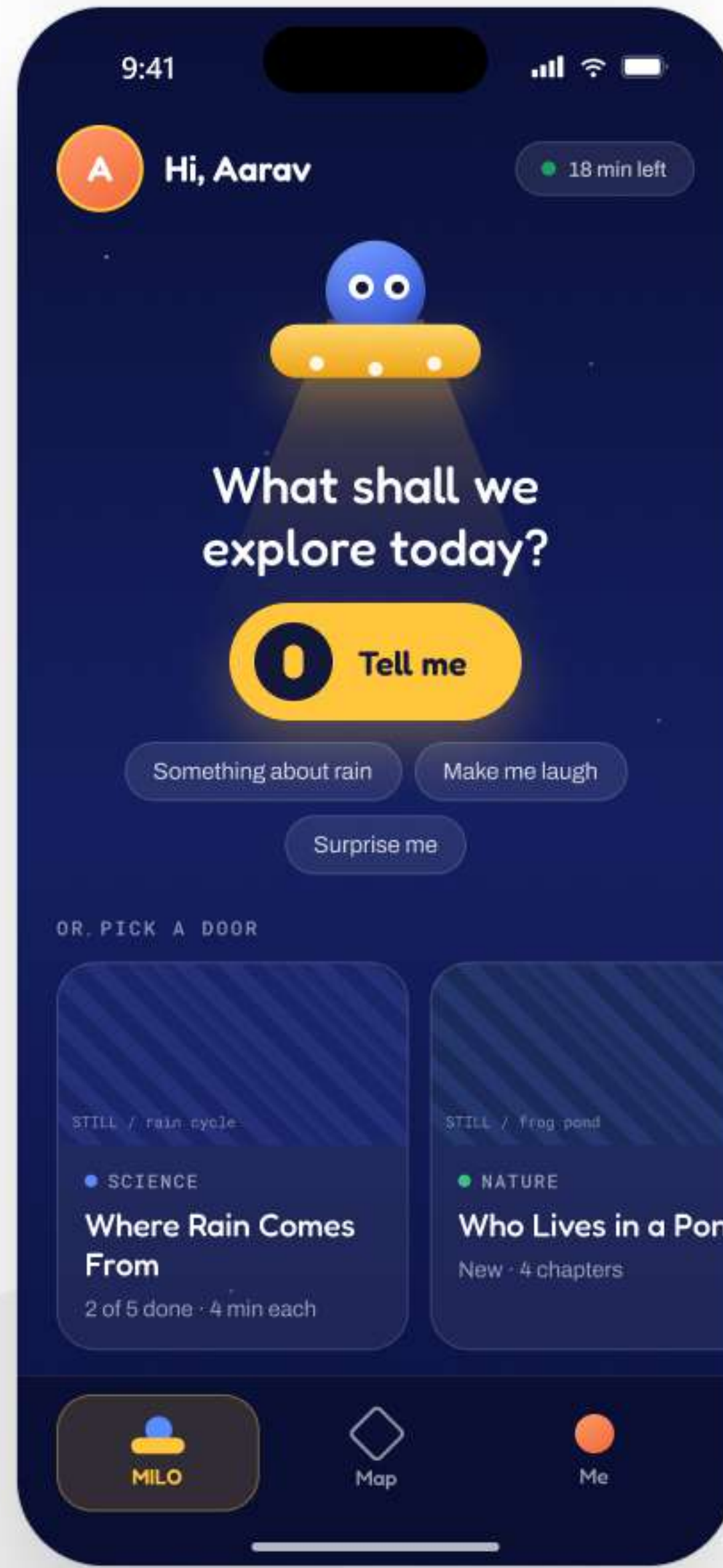
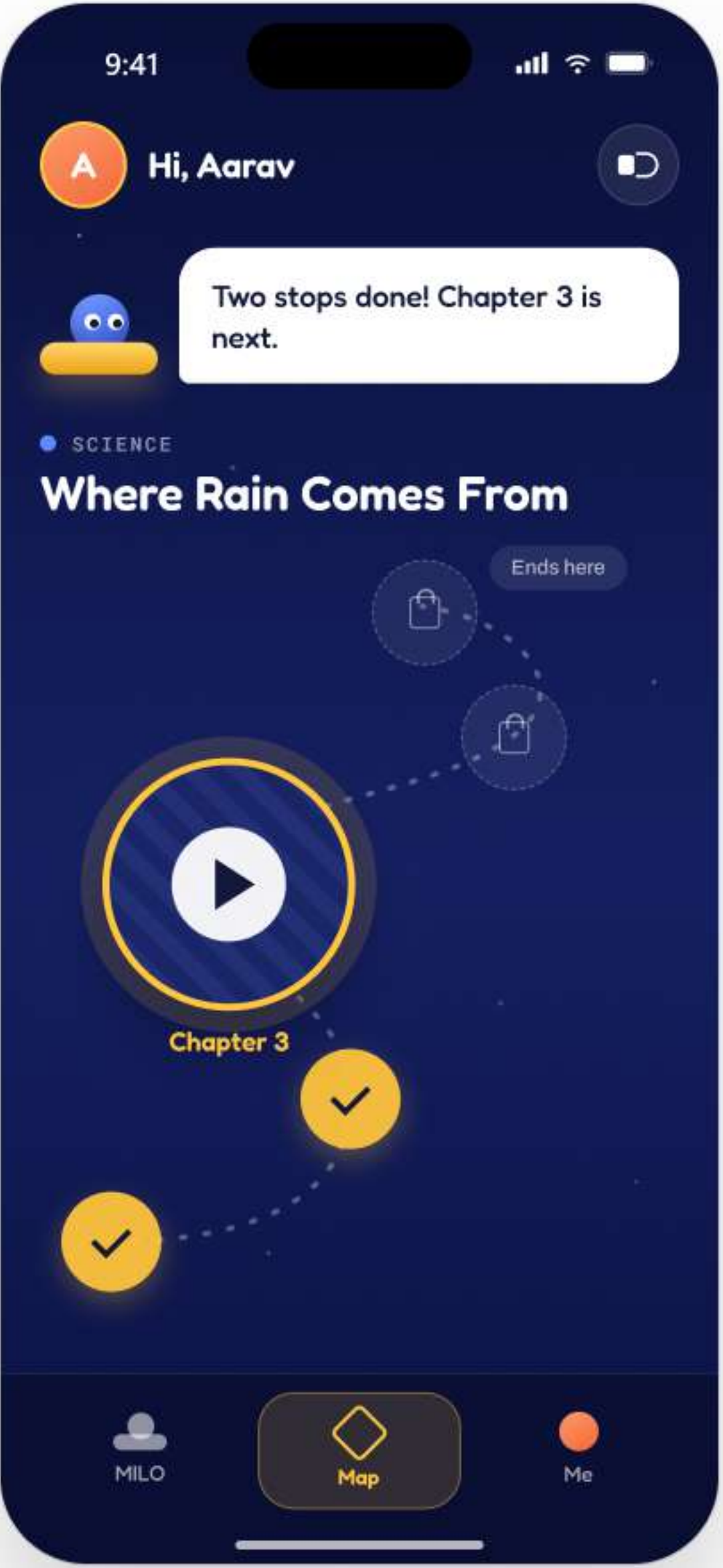
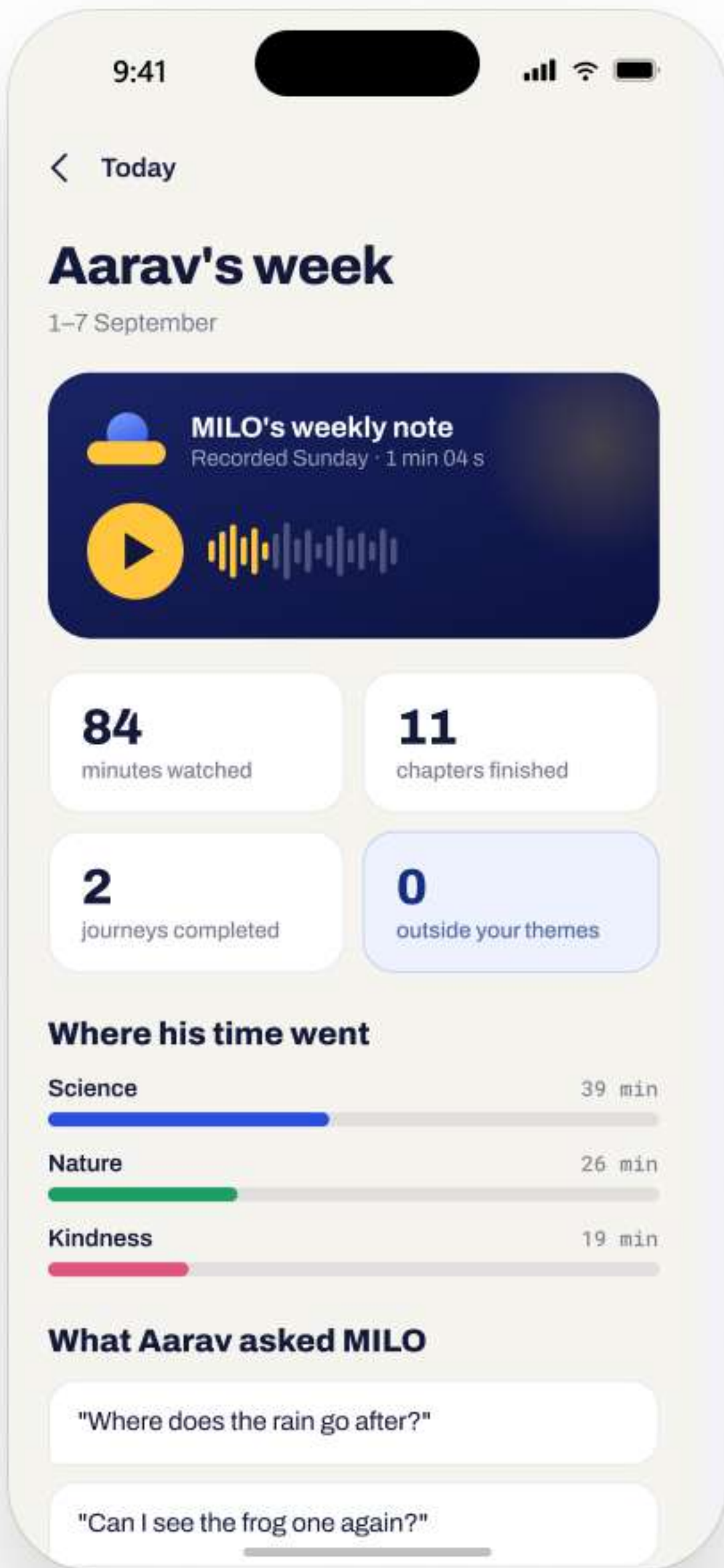
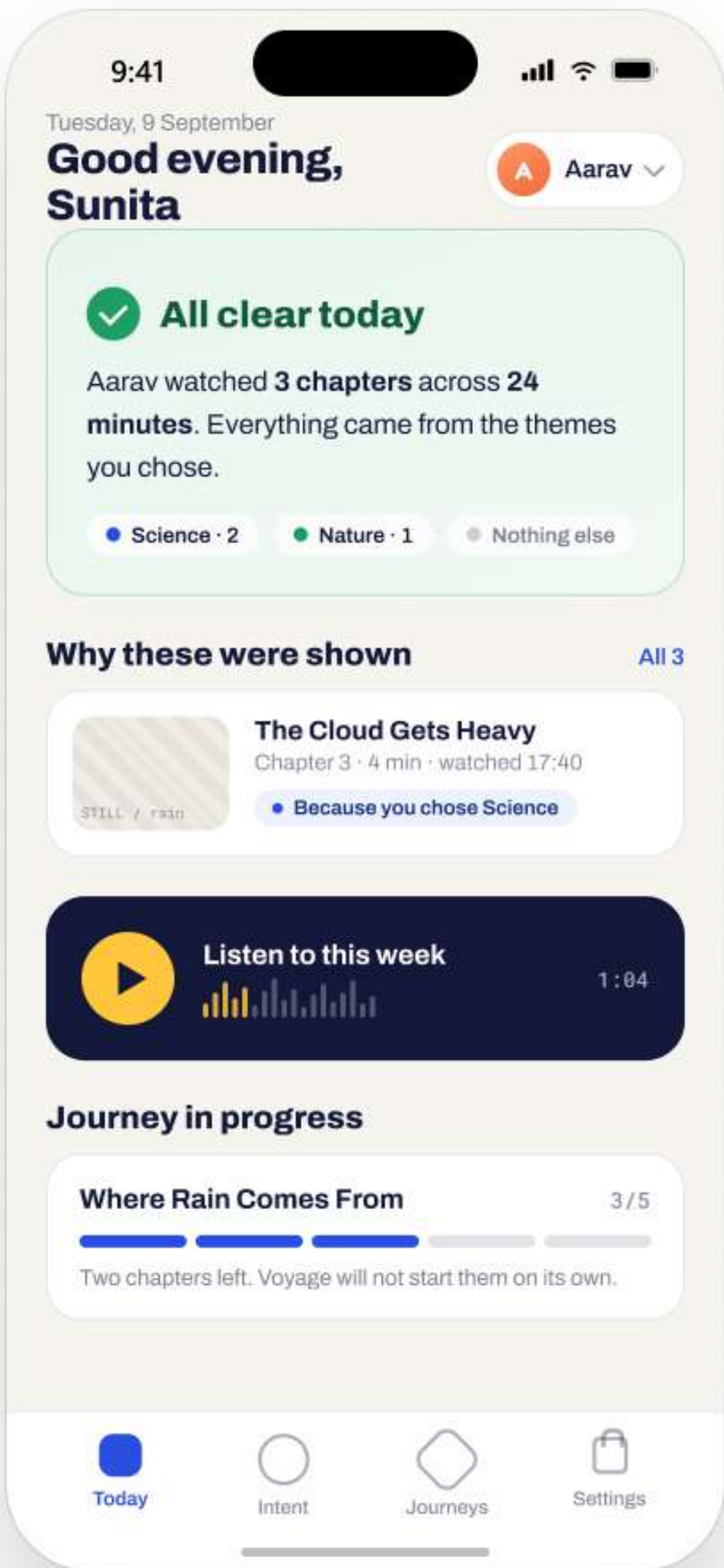
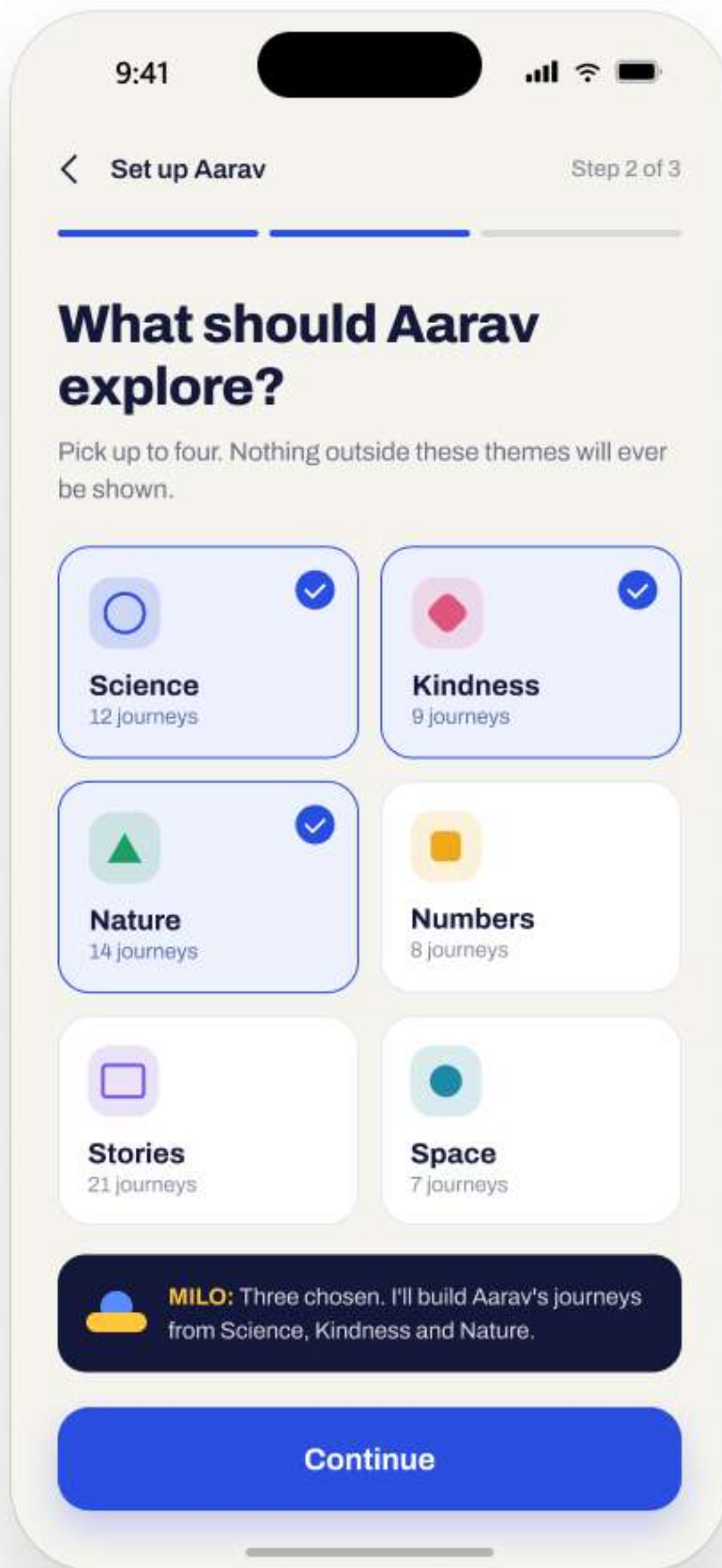
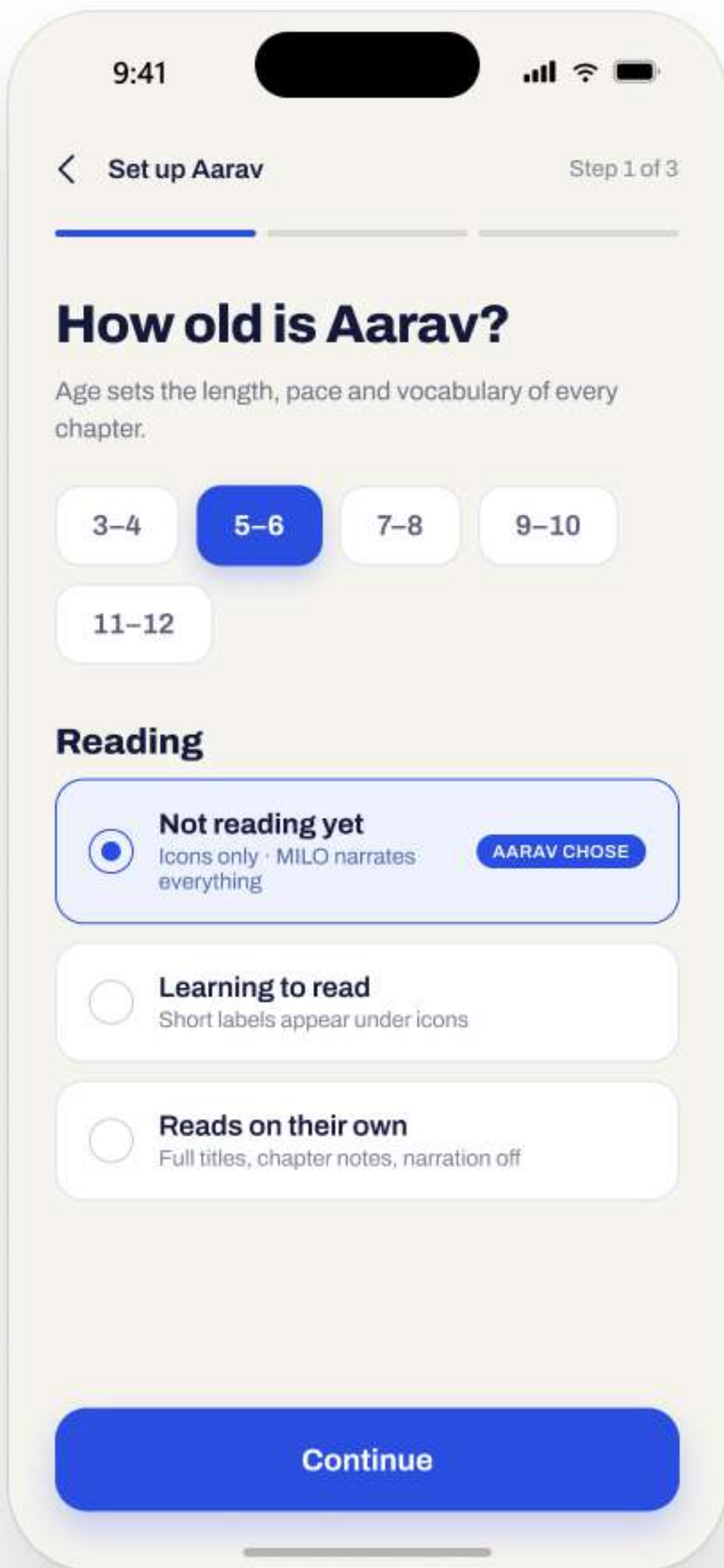
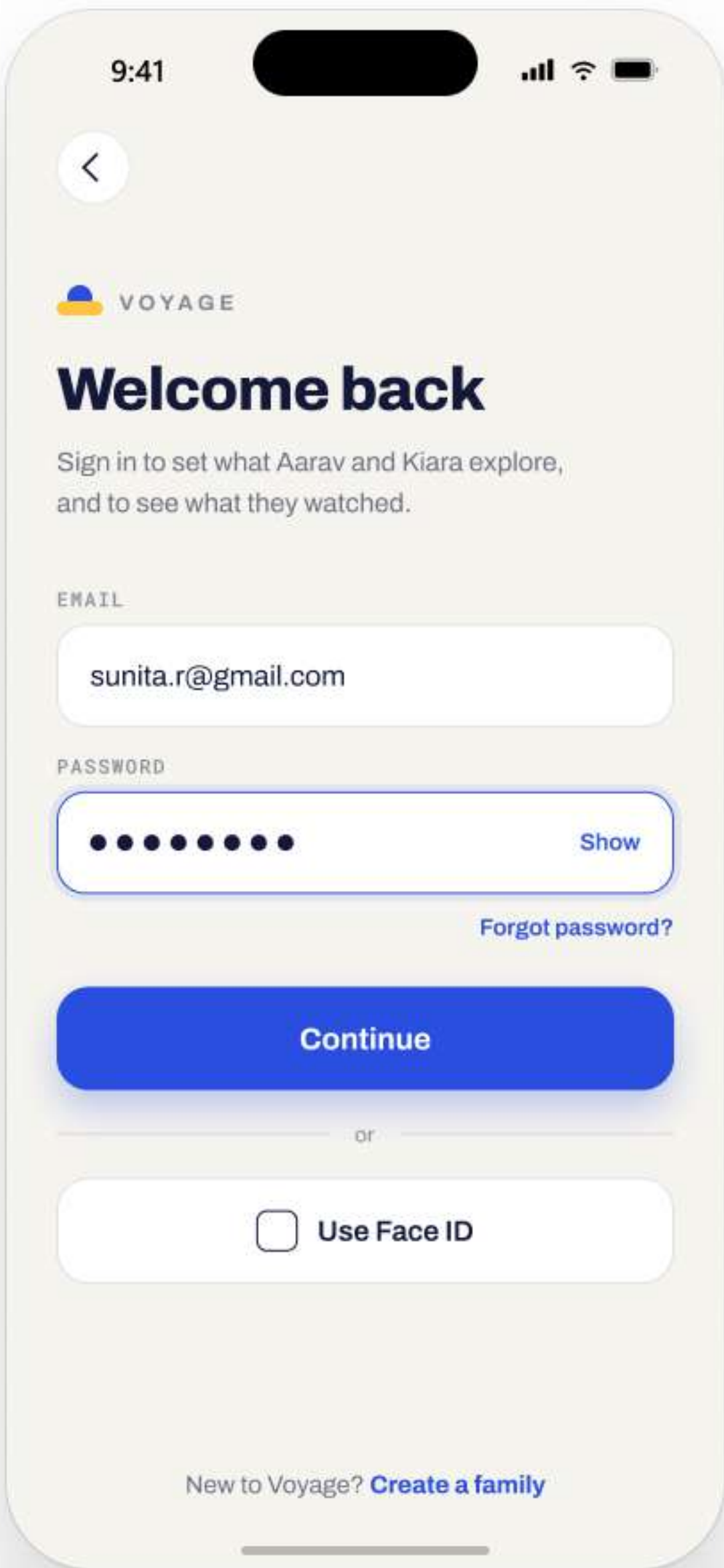


## 2. Child Discovers Content





# Hi- Fidelity Screens





# Thank you!

**Designed by**  
**Kshitiz Kumar Tirkey**

